

However, when utilizing a pre-built ecommerce solution, you won't have as much freedom in terms of design. There are many free and paid software which are available for this purpose. You'll be able to find such software in all categories and dimensions – free or paid, open source or closed source, classifieds or first-hand sale systems (or both). If you're already using a popular CMS such as Drupal or WordPress, then you can add plug-ins for the purpose! There are multiple solutions for setting up ecommerce sites online for various needs.

The problem here, however, is that you'll be restricted to the design of the system you choose. Yes, you can modify elements to suit your needs but there would be a limit to how much you can customize. To modify any pre-built system to suit your needs which are significantly different from what the design of that software allows, the work needed to be done rises exponentially – sometimes more than what's needed to design a system from scratch. Hence, although getting a pre-built solution makes it easy, it won't be flexible enough for the modifications you may need.

Some popular prebuilt e-commerce systems:

osCommerce – <http://www.oscommerce.com/>

ZenCart – <http://www.zen-cart.com/>

PrestaShop – <http://www.prestashop.com/>

Magento – <http://www.magentocommerce.com/>

Abante Cart – <http://www.abantecart.com/>

Spree Commerce – <http://spreecommerce.com/>

Drupal Commerce Plug-in for Drupal – <http://drupal.org/project/commerce>

WP e-commerce Plug-in for Wordpress – <http://wordpress.org/extend/plugins/wp-e-commerce/>

After building the website, you need to host it. Assess your primary needs and keep these three things in mind when looking for a host:

1. Technologies supported: Technology such as PHP 5.3, PostgreSQL/MySQL/Oracle, Python etc)
2. Bandwidth and storage provided: It can be minimum in the beginning but other plans with bigger limits and better values should be present.
3. Pricing and support: Pricing is usually competitive but good support from the host is important in case you want enhancements or are having technical troubles.

There's a big enough list to choose from when it comes to hosting. Some good hosts are: